

End-of-Lease Bond-Back Checklist — New South Wales

Protect your money — most bond disputes are avoidable with the right documentation.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Understand How Your Bond Works

- ☐ [] **Know your bond is lodged with NSW Fair Trading via Rental Bonds Online (RBO)**, not held by your landlord or agent directly.
- ☐ [] **Understand bond is not a general maintenance fund.** It can only be claimed against for unpaid rent, cleaning to restore the property to its condition at the start of the tenancy (allowing for fair wear and tear), or damage beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ [] **Know the fair wear and tear standard.** Normal deterioration — faded paint, minor carpet wear — isn't something you can be charged for. Damage from neglect is treated differently.

Section 2 — Before You Move Out

- ☐ [] **Locate your original entry condition report (Schedule 2 form)** — this is your baseline for comparison.
- ☐ [] **Compare the property's current condition against that report**, room by room.
- ☐ [] **Clean thoroughly**, addressing anything genuinely beyond fair wear and tear.
- ☐ [] **Check every item on the original inventory** is present and in working order.
- ☐ [] **Settle any outstanding rent** before vacating.

Section 3 — At the Final Inspection

- ☐ [] **Attend the final inspection if you can**, comparing the property against the original condition report together with your landlord/agent.
- ☐ [] **Take your own timestamped photos** of every room after cleaning, regardless of whether the agent attends.
- ☐ [] **Keep every receipt** — professional cleaning, carpet cleaning, pest control, repairs — as evidence.

Section 4 — Claiming Your Bond

- ☐ [] **Understand the mandatory end-of-tenancy survey.** Since 1 July 2025, landlords and agents must complete a short survey in Rental Bonds Online when claiming or releasing a bond, identifying who ended the tenancy and why. They generally have **14 days** from the initial bond claim to complete this survey.
- ☐ [] **Lodge your side of the bond claim through Rental Bonds Online** once you've vacated.
- ☐ [] **If both parties agree**, the bond is released according to the agreed split.
- ☐ [] **If there's a dispute**, either party can apply to the **NSW Civil and Administrative Tribunal (NCAT)** to resolve it.

Section 5 — If There's a Dispute

- ☐ [] **Gather your evidence before applying to NCAT:** entry and exit condition reports, timestamped photos, cleaning/repair receipts, and any correspondence with your landlord/agent.
- ☐ [] **Apply to NCAT** if you and your landlord can't agree — the Tribunal will review evidence from both sides and make a binding decision under the *Residential Tenancies Act 2010 (NSW)*.
- ☐ [] **Keep written evidence of everything**, including correspondence and receipts — this is explicitly what NSW Fair Trading recommends tenants retain in case of a dispute.

Quick Reference — NSW Bond Process

STEP	DETAIL
Bond holder	NSW Fair Trading, via Rental Bonds Online
End-of-tenancy survey	Mandatory since 1 July 2025, completed within 14 days of claim
Dispute resolution	NCAT (NSW Civil and Administrative Tribunal)
Fair wear and tear	Cannot be charged against your bond

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